Potato and kale soup (*caldo verde*) is ubiquitous in Portugal, where cooks use incredibly finely shredded cabbage. Here we have to substitute our own winter greens.

# portuguese potato and kale soup

**SERVES** 4 **PREP** 15–20 MINS **COOK** 20–25 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

1lb (450g) potatoes, peeled and sliced
4 garlic cloves, sliced
1 small onion, finely chopped
salt and freshly ground black pepper
8oz (225g) curly kale, or cavolo nero or Savoy cabbage
4oz (110g) chorizo, skin removed and sliced
extra virgin olive oil, to serve

1 Place the potato slices in a large saucepan with the garlic and onion. Season with salt and pepper and add enough water to cover generously. Simmer until tender. Pass through the fine blade of a mouli-legume, or mash to a smooth purée using a potato masher. Add a little more water if necessary to thin to a soupy consistency. Return to the pan and adjust the seasoning, adding plenty of pepper.

2 While the potatoes are cooking, cut the stems from the kale, then roll up the leaves and shred very thinly—the resulting threads of cabbage should be around ⅛in (3mm) wide. Bring the soup back to a boil. Stir in the kale and sausage. Simmer for 5 minutes. Ladle into soup bowls, pour a little olive oil into each, and serve.



**KALE**
Intense in flavor and vibrant in color, use locally grown kale with firm stems and fresh, curly leaves. Or you could grow this hardy vegetable yourself. The tough central stems should be removed before cooking.